Born rule. As counterintuitive as Many-Worlds might seem, at the end of the day it doesn't really change how we should go through our lives.

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So far we've treated branching of the wave function as something that happens independently of ourselves, so that we simply have to go along for the ride. It's worth asking whether that's the proper perspective. Whenever I make a decision, are different worlds created where I chose different things? Are there realities out there corresponding to every series of alternative choices I could have made, universes that actualize all the possibilities of my life?

The idea of "making a decision" isn't something inscribed in the fundamental laws of physics. It's one of those useful, approximate, emergent notions that we find convenient to invoke when describing human-scale phenomena. What you and I label "making a decision" is a set of neurochemical processes happening in our brain. It's perfectly okay to talk about making decisions, but it's not something over and above ordinary material stuff obeying the laws of physics.

So the question is, do the physical processes going on in your brain when you make a decision *cause* the wave function of the universe to branch, with different decisions being made in each branch? If I'm playing poker and lose all my chips after making an ill-timed bluff, can I take solace in the idea that there is another branch where I played more conservatively?

No, you do not cause the wave function to branch by making a decision. In large part that's just due to what we mean (or ought to mean) by something "causing" something else. Branching is the result of a microscopic process amplified to macroscopic scales: a system in a quantum superposition becomes entangled with a larger system, which then becomes entangled with the environment, leading to decoherence. A decision, on the other hand, is a purely macroscopic phenomenon. There are no decisions being made by the electrons and atoms inside your brain; they're just obeying the laws of physics.

Decisions and choices and their consequences are useful concepts when we are talking about things at the macroscopic, human-size level. It's perfectly okay to think of choices as really existing and having influences,